proscribed JuD following the 2008 Mumbai attacks that this loophole was closed.

Fundraising was not the only area in which JuD's legality made a difference in terms of the type of operating environment the group enjoyed versus what other outfits had to contend with. At various times, the Musharraf regime ordered all of the groups to close their liaison offices in Pakistan, making open recruitment more difficult. Not only were most of the Deobandi groups banned, meaning they had to disguise their activities in some way, but their charitable wings and hence those offices were scrutinized more heavily than those official belonging to JuD.[57] This meant that Lashkar could continue to use its infrastructure for missionary purposes in order to build a support base as well as to recruit more openly.[58] The group purchased real estate throughout the country in order to open up new offices and had more than 1,500 full time offices operating across Pakistan by the middle of the decade.[59]

The group's propaganda operations also remained intact. Although other outfits continued to put out propaganda, they could not do so as overtly or on such a grand scale because what they were doing was technically illegal. Once again, everything done under the JuD umbrella was legit. All of the group's existing propaganda offerings migrated from MDI to JuD, and ultimately increased to nine print publications as well as enhanced virtual offerings.[60] Its *Al-Dawa* magazine continued to claim the highest monthly circulation among jihadi monthlies; *Ghazwa Times*, which previously had the second highest circulation among weeklies, jumped to the top spot.[61] JuD's website and publications still detailed Lashkar attacks in Indian-administered Kashmir despite the ostensible separation of the two groups.[62] A number of the author's Pakistani interlocutors also pointed out that Saeed and other JuD preachers enjoyed far more freedom of movement than leaders of other organizations. This enabled them to travel around, promote Lashkar's jihad and raise money. A number of Pakistani journalists told the author the ISI also warned members of the media it was acceptable to write critically about other outfits, but to lay off Lashkar. Several of them reported receiving threatening phone calls from the security services directing them to cease publishing negative stories about the group.[63]

Its reputation experienced an additional boost following its response to the South Asia Earthquake, as it is now known, which struck Pakistan,